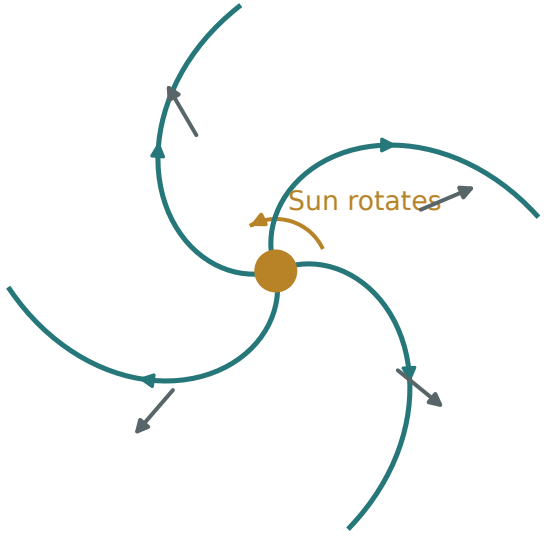
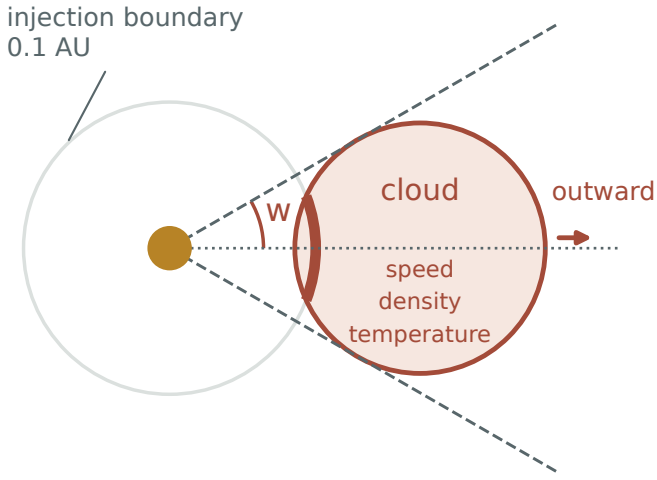
The Parker spiral and the cone model

A Parker spiral: field lines and wind



Teal: magnetic field lines at one instant
Grey: direction of the wind, nearly radial

B Cone model of a CME



Dashed lines: edges of the cone; w is the half-width.
Thick arc: boundary cells that take the cloud's values.

Sketches for illustration. Between the cloud and the Sun, the cone holds only ordinary wind.